

MR Credit: Environmental Product Declarations

1–2 Points

This credit applies to

- BD+C: New Construction
- BD+C: Core & Shell
- BD+C: Schools
- BD+C: Retail
- BD+C: Data Centers
- BD+C: Warehouses & Distribution Centers
- BD+C: Hospitality
- BD+C: Healthcare

INTENT

To encourage the use of products and materials for which life-cycle information is available and that have environmentally, economically, and socially preferable life-cycle impacts. To reward project teams for selecting products from manufacturers who have verified improved environmental life-cycle impacts.

REQUIREMENTS

Achieve one or more of the options below, for a maximum of 2 points.

Option 1. Environmental Product Declaration – EPD (1 point)

Use at least 20 different permanently installed products sourced from at least five different manufacturers that meet one of the disclosure criteria below. (10 different permanently installed products from three different manufacturers for CS and Warehouses & Distribution Centers).

- Products with a publicly available, critically reviewed life-cycle assessment conforming to ISO 14044 (at least cradle to gate scope) are valued as one whole product.
- Product-specific Type III EPD – Internally Reviewed: Products with an internally critically reviewed LCA per ISO 14071, conforming to ISO 14025 and EN 15804 or ISO 21930 (at least cradle to gate) are valued as one whole product.
- Industry-wide Type III EPD: Products with third-party certification (Type III), including external verification, conforming to ISO 14025 and EN 15804 or ISO 21930 (at least cradle to gate) are valued as one whole product.
- Product-specific Type III EPD with third-party certification, external verification AND external critical review are valued as 1.5 products.

Option 2. Embodied Carbon/LCA Optimization (1 point)

Use products that have a compliant embodied carbon optimization report or action plan separate from the LCA or EPD. Use at least 5 permanently installed products sourced from at least three different manufacturers.

Report type	Reference Document(s)	Report Verification	Valuation
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Embodied Carbon/LCA Action Plan	Product-specific LCA or product-specific Type III EPD	Prepared by manufacturer, signed by company executive	1/2 product
Reductions in Embodied Carbon: <10% reduction in GWP	Baseline: Product-specific LCA, Product-specific Type III EPD, or Industry-wide Type III EPD Optimized: Product-specific LCA or product-specific Type III EPD	Comparative analysis verified by independent party	1 product
Reductions in Embodied Carbon: 10%+ reduction in GWP	Same as above	Same as above	1.5 products
Reductions in Embodied Carbon: 20%+ reduction in GWP and 5%+ reduction in two additional impact categories	Baseline: Product-specific LCA or Type III EPD Optimized: Product-specific LCA or Type III EPD	Same as above	2 products

Impact categories assessed:

- Global warming potential (greenhouse gases), in CO₂e
- Depletion of the stratospheric ozone layer, in kg CFC-11e
- Acidification of land and water sources, in moles H⁺ or kg SO₂e
- Eutrophication, in kg nitrogen equivalent or kg phosphate equivalent
- Formation of tropospheric ozone, in kg NO_x, kg O₃ eq, or kg ethene
- Depletion of nonrenewable energy resources, in MJ using CML / depletion of fossil fuels in TRACI

For credit achievement calculation, products sourced (extracted, manufactured, purchased) within 100 miles (160 km) of the project site are valued at twice their base contributing number of products, up to a maximum of 2 products.

GUIDANCE – Behind the Intent

Beta Update

The prevalence of EPDs has grown significantly since LEED v4 was introduced in 2012. For Option 1, partial weightings have been removed to simplify project team selection. All compliant product-specific LCAs and EPDs are now worth one whole product, with one exception: third-party certified Type III EPDs with external verification of the LCA are valued at 1.5 products. The number of products threshold has been reduced for CS and Warehouse projects due to their reduced project scopes.

For Option 2, the cost threshold has been removed. Option 2 now has only a number-of-products-based threshold: procure 5 products from at least three different manufacturers. An entry-level pathway rewards action plans for those who demonstrate initiative towards reducing life cycle impacts.

GUIDANCE – Calculations

Equation 1: Total number of products with EPDs (Option 1)

Total # of products = {# products with product-specific/industry-specific/internally verified Type III EPDs × 1} + {# Type III EPDs with external verification and external critical review × 1.5}

Equation 3: Total number of products with Embodied Carbon/LCA Optimization Reports (Option 2)

Total # = {# action plans × 0.5 × location factor} + {# products with any third-party verified GWP reduction × 1 × location factor} + {# products with 10%+ GWP reduction × 1.5 × location factor} + {# products with 20%+ GWP and 5%+ in 2 other categories × 2 × location factor}

Note: no single product may contribute more than 2× value. Location valuation factor = 2 for products within 100 miles.

EXEMPLARY PERFORMANCE

- Option 1: Purchase at least 40 qualifying permanently installed building products from ten different manufacturers (20 products from five manufacturers for CS and W&D; Centers).
- Option 2: Purchase at least 10 compliant products from five different manufacturers.

REQUIRED DOCUMENTATION

- Option 1: Use the LEED v4.1 MR building product calculator. For GBCI-verified products, include Verified for LEED Documentation ID numbers, or copies of EPD/LCA reports in LEED Online.
- Option 2: Use the LEED v4.1 MR building product calculator. Include ID numbers or copies of action plans and optimization reports in LEED Online.

CONNECTION TO ONGOING PERFORMANCE

- LEED O+M MR prerequisite Waste Performance, MR prerequisite Purchasing Policy, and MR credit Purchasing: A similar credit having some of the above requirements for existing buildings is required for the O+M v4.1 rating system.